

Partner Program Certification – Advanced

Services (basic services plus these below)

Base IT Support & Ticketing

- Mastery of ticketing systems like Jira: creation, assignment, escalation, comments.
- Proficiency in ITIL processes, especially Incident and Change Management.
- Effective prioritization, multitasking, SLA awareness, strong customer communication, and issue resolution capabilities.

Architecture & Design

- Design of Hybrid & Multi-Cloud Environments: Craft secure, scalable, highly available infrastructure architectures across hybrid landscapes.
- Strategic Sensor Placement & Visibility: Plan and optimize sensor deployments for maximum network observability and resilience.
- Business Continuity Planning (BCP): Develop systems and processes to ensure continuity during failures or disasters.

Networking & Firewall Services

- Deep understanding of TCP/IP, UDP, ICMP, subnetting, routing.
- Expertise in firewall technologies, access control lists, and security policies.
- Design and troubleshoot complex VLAN, trunking, SPAN, port mirroring, and packet-brokering deployments across heterogeneous environments.
- Implement high-availability and fault-tolerant network architectures with redundancy and seamless failover.
- Hands-on experience with network hardware deployment, connectivity troubleshooting, and performance optimization.

Virtualization Management

- Proficiency with VMware, Hyper-V, KVM.
- Skilled in virtual networking, storage, compute resource management, and lifecycle of virtual machines.

Host OS / Hypervisor Administration

- Administration of Windows and Linux systems.

- Knowledge of ESXi, Hyper V, Xen.
- Performance monitoring, system optimization, and strong troubleshooting skills.
- Leverage tools like Ansible and Kickstart for automated, consistent OS deployments across infrastructures.
- Streamline updates, patch cycles, and compliance checks via repeatable automation processes.

Docker & Container Services

- Expert in containerization concepts, Docker engine, linux namespaces, deploying via Docker Hub.
- Competence in Docker networking, storage, and resolving container-related issues.
- Architect overlay networks, hardened namespaces, and secure container isolation for production environments.
- Deploy hardened clusters with best-practice configurations for network segmentation and access control.

Third-Party Software Integration

- Integrate systems with SIEM platforms for centralized event monitoring, correlation, and advanced threat analysis.
- Offer outsourced security operations including 24/7 monitoring, investigation, triage, and remediation.
- Enhance detection capabilities using automated and analyst-driven threat hunting supported by SIEM tools.

Software-Defined Networking (SDN)

- Understanding of SDN architecture and controllers like NSX.
- Implementation of network virtualization, automation, and SDN-related troubleshooting.

Cloud Services (AWS, Azure, GCP, etc.)

- Familiar with cloud platforms' compute, storage, networking, and security features.
- Capable of Identity and Access Management and troubleshooting cloud infrastructure issues.

Reporting

- Develop dashboards and reports focused on RPO (Recovery Point Objective), RTO (Recovery Time Objective), and system availability during disruptions.
- Provide threat intelligence reporting with trend analysis, log correlation, and executive summaries derived from SIEM and analytics platforms.



Kubernetes Services

- Proficiency in Kubernetes architecture—Pods, Services, Deployments, Namespaces.
- Proficiency in kubectl, container orchestration, networking/storage within clusters, and troubleshooting K8s environments.

Go-Live & Support

- Establish failover strategies, fallback protocols, and runbook-driven practices to ensure operational stability during crises.
- Ensure smooth go-live transitions with adherence to SLAs and minimal downtime.
- Conduct tabletop or technical drills to validate incident readiness and response effectiveness.

Training Services (Add-On)

- Instruction on ITIL, ticketing, SLAs, network/firewall setup, virtualization, OS/Hypervisor administration, containerization (Docker/Kubernetes), SDN, cloud technologies, cybersecurity frameworks, risk/vulnerability tools, incident response, and GuardDog AI technology.

Cybersecurity Retainer & Services

- Annual retainer model (e.g., \$50k/year).
- Expertise in frameworks and standards, risk assessment, vulnerability management, incident response, forensic analysis, encryption, security policy development, and regulatory compliance.
- Implement structured, unstructured, and situational hunts across systems, logs, and endpoints to detect sophisticated threats early.
- Utilize SIEM tools for real-time detection, correlation, forensic analysis, and compliance-driven alerting.
- Provide 24/7 detection, investigation, and remediation through managed security services.



Partner Certification Program – Phase 2

A comprehensive accreditation path for partners or internal staff to gain advanced competencies and validation.

Certification Tracks:

Architecture & Design

- Skills: translating reference architectures, designing scalable, secure networks, sensor planning.
- Certifications: Cisco CCNP (Design), CompTIA Security+.
- Assessment: architecture creation from requirements; critique of flawed designs.

Procurement

- Skills: BOM creation, spec matching, licensing strategies, vendor coordination.
- Certifications: Vendor-specific & procurement training.
- Assessment: BOM generation case study; scenario-based hardware delivery planning.

Advanced OS Installation & Automation

- Focus: OS installation with advanced automation—Kickstart, Ansible, patch management.
- Assessment: automated deployment lab scenario.

Advanced Network Configuration

- Focus: multi-switch, multi-vendor configs—complex VLANs, trunking, SPAN, packet brokering, port mirroring.

Advanced Deployment (Containers & Isolation)

- Skills: overlay networking, Linux namespaces, isolation, production-grade security, Docker & Kubernetes practices.
- Certifications: Docker DCA, Kubernetes CKA (recommended).
- Assessment: secure isolated multi-container deployment with custom networking.

Third-Party Software Integration

- Skills: integrations with Splunk, ELK, Domo; API and agent setups; data integrity.
- Assessment: sensor-to-dashboard integration lab and failure-handling scenario.

Reporting

- Skills: data normalization, baseline reporting, executive summaries.
- Assessment: create a vulnerability/security posture report.



Go-Live & Support

- Skills: production cutovers, SLA creation and enforcement, 24/7 runbook readiness, failure simulations.
- Certification: ITIL Foundation.
- Assessment: incident simulation within SLA constraints.

Incident Response

- Skills: anomaly detection, vulnerability lifecycle, threat hunting, log analysis, attack surface reduction.
- Certifications: GCIH, CompTIA CySA+.
- Assessment: red team/blue team intrusion detection and response.

Cloud Add-On Module

- Skills: multi-cloud architecture (AWS, GCP, Azure, OCI, SoftLayer), container/serverless deployment, network integration, security and IR/reporting.
- Certifications: Cloud Solutions Architect – Associate, Kubernetes CKA.
- Assessment: hybrid on-prem/cloud deployment; cloud-based incident investigation.